KK-H-566a

SEPTEMBER 9, 1939

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. KK-H-566
November 19, 1935

FEDERAL STANDARD STOCK CATALOG

Section IV

(Part 5)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FOR

HOLSTERS, PISTOL; LEATHER

This specification was approved on the above date by the Director of Procurement, for the use of all departments and establishments of the Government, and shall become effective not later than June 15, 1940. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation.

A. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS.

A-1. The following Federal Specifications, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, shall form a part of this specification.

KK-L-271—Leather, strap, black and russet.
DDD-S-751—Stitches, seams, and stitching.

B. TYPES, GRADE, AND CLASSES.

B-1. Pistol holsters shall be furnished in one grade and in the following types and classes, as specified in the invitation for bids. (See par. I-1.)

- Type I—Open-end.
  - Class A—Pocket with safety strap.
  - Class B—Open-pocket.
  - Class C—Extended-belt-loop (with safety strap).
- Type II—Closed-end.
  - Class A—Pocket with safety strap.
  - Class B—Open-pocket.
  - Class C—Pocket with flap.

C. MATERIAL AND WORKMANSHIP.

C-1. *Material.*—

C-1a. *Leather.*—The leather used in making the holster shall be in accordance with Federal Specification KK-L-271. (See par. E-1.)

C-1b. *Thread.*—Five-cord brown or black (to conform to color of leather) linen thread shall be used for all stitching. (See par. E-2.)

C-1c. *Rivets.*—Copper machine rivets with capped ends shall be used. The rivets shall be finished in black where black leather is used and shall be natural metal finish where brown leather is used.

C-2. *Workmanship.*—Workmanship shall be first-class and in accordance with recognized commercial practice.

D. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS.

D-1. The holsters shall be so designed that the pistol will securely fit without undue binding.

E. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS.

E–1. *Leather.*—

E–1a. *Selection.*—Holsters shall be made with leather free from cuts, open scratches, open grub holes, brands, and deep wrinkles.

E–1b. *Finish.*—The leather shall be finished smooth with full grain. Light snuffing of the grain shall be permitted.

E–1c. *Color.*—The color shall be natural russet or black, as specified in the invitation for bids. When specified, the leather shall be darkened by treatment with neatsfoot oil.

E–1d. *Thickness.*—Unless otherwise specified, the thickness of the leather shall be 7/64 inch. A plus tolerance of 3/4 sixty-fourth inch and a minus tolerance of 1/2 sixty-fourth inch shall be permitted.

E–2. *Stitching.*—Stitch type 301, Federal Specification DDD–S–751, shall be used. There shall be from 6 to 8 stitches per inch. The thread shall be waxed. Ends of threads shall be securely fastened.

E–3. *Construction.*—

E–3a. *Type I, Open-end.*—

E–3a (1). *Class A, Pocket with safety strap.*—The pocket shall be made of one-piece leather molded into shape to hold a pistol. Between the joined ends of the pocket a leather welt shall be inserted which shall be not less than 3/16 inch thick and 3/8 inch wide. The welt and ends shall be joined together with a cellulose base leather cement. Each end-joint shall be secured with a rivet. The bottom of the pocket shall be open. A belt loop shall be formed by turning a section of the body of the holster pocket upon itself. The ends of the loop shall be sewed to a strap with a double row of stitching. Each end of loop section shall be secured to the strap by a rivet. The strap shall be not less than 5/8 inch in width and where the ends of the strap overlap they may be tapered. The strap shall completely encircle the pocket but shall not be attached thereto. The belt loop shall be not less than 2½ inches in width and not less than 2 inches down to the top of the strap. The top of the pocket shall be provided with a safety strap which shall be secured to the back of the holster with a rivet. The width of the strap shall be not less than 5/8 inch. The end of the strap shall be provided with a snap button cap to close onto a male section, attached to the outside of the pocket. The snap button cap shall be approximately 3/4 inch from the end of the strap.

E–3a (2). *Class B, Open-pocket.*—The pistol holster of this class shall be identical in detail to type I, class A, except that there shall not be any safety strap on pockets.

E–3a (3). *Class C, extended-belt-loop, with safety strap.*—The pocket shall be made of one-piece leather molded into shape to hold a pistol. Between the joined ends of the pocket a leather welt shall be inserted which shall be not less than 3/16 inch thick and 3/8 inch wide. The welt and ends shall be joined together with a cellulose-base leather cement and sewed. Each end joint shall be secured with a rivet. The bottom of the pocket shall be open. A belt loop shall be formed by the use of a separate piece of leather. The top of the loop shall extend approximately 4 inches above the top of the pistol pocket. The loop shall be sewed to the pocket in such a manner that a completely enclosed seam is formed, and one side of the seam shall coincide with the pocket seam. The belt loop shall have the grain side of the leather on the outside and shall be attached to the back of the pocket by having one side of the loop on the inside of the pocket and the other side of the loop on the outside of the pocket. The opening of the belt loop shall be not less than 2½ inches down. The top of the pocket shall be provided with a safety strap which shall be secured to the back of the holster with a rivet. The width of the strap shall be not less than ⅝ inch. The end of the strap shall be provided with a snap button cap to close onto a male section attached to the outside of the pocket. The snap button cap shall be approximately ¾ inch from the end of the strap.

E–3b. *Type II. Closed-end.*—

E–3b (1). *Class A pocket with safety strap.*—The pistol holster of this type and class shall be identical in detail with Type I, Class A, pistol holster, except that the bottom of the pocket shall be closed.

E–3b (2). *Class B open-pocket.*—The pistol holster of this type and class shall be identical in detail with Type I, Class B, except that the bottom of the pocket shall be closed.

E–3b (3). *Class C pocket with flap.*—The pocket shall be made of one-piece leather molded into shape to hold a pistol. Between the joined ends of the pocket a leather welt shall be inserted which shall be not less than 3/16-inch thick and-⅝ inch wide. The welt and ends shall be joined together with a cellulose-base leather cement. Each end-joint shall be secured with a rivet. The bottom of the pocket shall be closed. The flap of the pocket shall be formed by turning a section of the body of the holster pocket. The flap shall be provided with a snap button cap to close onto a male section attached to the outside of the pocket. A belt loop shall be sewed to the back of the pocket. Each end of the loop shall have a double row of stitching. The sewing shall either be endless stitching or shall extend beyond the loop section in such manner as to prevent ripping. The belt loop shall be not less than 2 inches in width and have an opening not less than 3 inches.

E–3c. *Rivets.*—The exposed surface of any rivet, on the inside of the holster, shall be finished smoothly and flush with the surface of the leather.

F. METHODS OF SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TESTS.

F–1. *Sampling.*—One holster shall be taken at random from each lot of 50, or fraction thereof, for inspection and tests.

F–2. *Leather.*—The leather shall be tested in accordance with the methods contained in Federal Specification KK–L–271.

G. PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING FOR SHIPMENT.

G–1. *Packaging.*—Unless otherwise specified, commercial packages are acceptable under this specification.

G–2. *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be delivered in substantial commercial wooden containers (boxes or cases) of either nailed or wire-bound construction, so constructed as to insure safe delivery by common or other carriers to the point of delivery at the lowest rate, and to withstand storage, re-handling, and reshipment without the necessity for repacking. A single container, when packed for shipment, shall weigh not in excess of approximately 150 pounds gross. Not more than one kind of holster shall be packed in a single container.

G–3. *Marking.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of material, the type, the class, and the quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H-1. *Army.*—This specification is not intended to cover holsters for military use. War Department purchases will be made under the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids of War Department Specification No. 52-3-2, holsters, pistol and revolver.

H-2. *Navy.*—General Specifications for Inspection of Material, copies of which may be obtained without cost upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington, D. C.

I. NOTES.

I-1. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and should specify in the invitations for bids the type, class, and color desired. Invitations for bids should contain the following information: Name of pistol, length of barrel, model, caliber, automatic or revolver, and, if revolver, whether single or double action, also the manner in which the pistol shall fit the holster.

I-2. It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

I-3. This specification covers only the types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity as generally purchased by the Federal Government, and is not intended to include all of the types, etc., which are commercially available.

I-4. An Index of Federal Specifications may be purchased as noted in the paragraph next below, price to be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

I-5. Copies of this specification and of those referred to in paragraph A-1 may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., price 5 cents each, except DDD-S-751, price 25 cents.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data, are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.